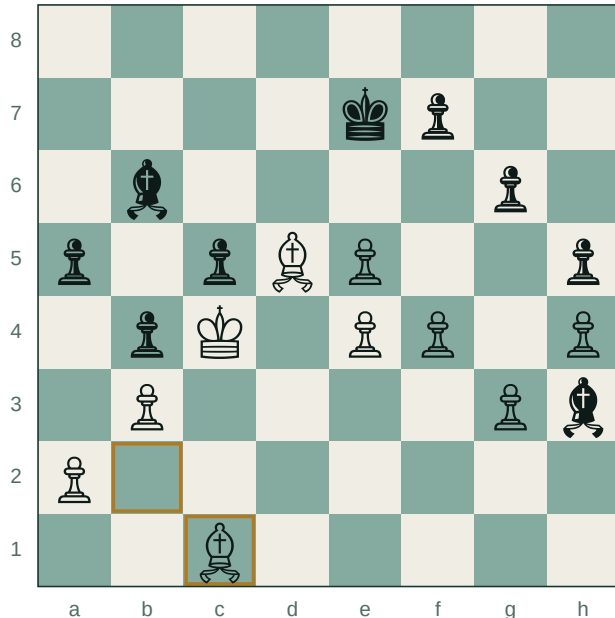


Bishop-ending decisions: Black, move 38

Bishop-ending decisions

Black to move



Previous move: 38.Bc1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38...Bf1#

38...Bf1# Mate: bishop on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c4. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Bishop on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Same-colored and opposite-colored bishop endings have different tendencies, but neither label replaces calculation of the actual pawn races.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A bishop ending depends on diagonal access, pawn color, king activity, and promotion squares. Tactics can arise when a bishop must perform two defensive jobs.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the bishop's line to each target and identify pawns that can break its coverage or force it to move.

The defending king is on c4. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c1. Check for tactical protection.